



Minnehaha United Methodist Church

Christmas Eve *Worship*

December 24
4:00 PM





Minnehaha United Methodist Church

A Reconciling Congregation

We Seek We Serve We Celebrate

Welcome Friends!

We welcome you to worship wherever you may be in your faith's journey. We strive to live in the way of Jesus Christ, sharing God's love on a daily basis regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history.

We livestream our worship services, and you may end up in view of the camera at any point in the service.

Worship Personnel

Rev. Becky Sechrist, *Pastor*;
Rev. Jean Elliott, *Director of Children, Youth, & Their Families*;
Anders Nelson, *Organist*;
Tim Siefkes, *Band Leader*;
Cindy Bergstrom, *Choir Director*;
Nicholas Sabah & John Davis, *Communion Stewards*

Minnehaha United Methodist Church acknowledges that we gather on the traditional, ancestral, and contemporary land of Dakota People.

Attendance

We are delighted you are here! We invite you to "sign the welcome pad" electronically.

If you point your camera phone at the QR code, it will take you to a Google form where you can enter your information.



Offering

For our offering, you can also give electronically through the PayPal account online, or by using this QR Code (which takes you to our PayPal account).



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December 24 2025 4:00 p.m.

* Please rise in body or spirit

Children in Worship

We always welcome children in worship! We assume that they may make noise, wiggle, and even run around. The nursery, located on the 2nd floor, is available for parents to use if you'd like more room to move around and play. The worship service is live-streamed into the nursery. In addition, we have activity bags for children at the back of the sanctuary. Rocking chairs are also available for nursing or rocking at the back of the sanctuary and in the nursery.

Gathering Music

Matt Hughes, vocals

Brightest Star
©2004 Chris Isaak; C Isaak Music Pub Comp (ASCAP)

Welcome

Lighting of the Advent Wreath Trevor, Kayla, Parker, Rylan, Kyler, & Sarah Hicks

Leader: Throughout the month of December, we have been preparing for this night.

People: **We began with the single candle of hope, a single flame bringing light into the darkness.**

Leader: We then lit the candle of peace, a daring prayer amidst the conflict in and all around us.

People: **As we lit the candle of peace, we were challenged to live lives of peace.**

Leader: Joy was our next candle, reminding us that even as the days get shorter, joy can reside in our souls.

People: **We pledged to bring more joy in our own lives and into the lives of others.**

Leader: Just this last Sunday, we lit the candle of love.

People: **Love that sits as the source of our lives, love that motivates us to live lives as an expression of God's love.**

Leader: Tonight, we light the candle at the center, the Christ candle.

People: **May we know the good news that God comes to us in human form; unto us a child is born. A light shines in the darkness and the darkness cannot overcome it. Glory to God in the highest heaven!**

(light the candles of hope, peace, joy, love and the Christ Candle)

*Hymn

O Come, All Ye Faithful #234 vv. 1-4

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

John F. Wade (ca. 1743)

in v. 2 feel free to sing "Maker" instead of "Father"

Christmas Prayer

(adapted from *Flames of the Spirit*, ed. Ruth C. Duck)

Loving God, you have come to us, not with great signs and wonders, but in a babe who became a humble carpenter. You took on human form, not with the trappings of power and might, but among folk who fasted, prayed, and gave thanks in the midst of their poverty. You sent Jesus to us from your very self, born as a human baby, to live among us and show us the way to new life. In response to your great labor of love, may we open ourselves to you, that you may create new life among us. Amen.

The Lord's Prayer

inclusive

Our Creator, God in heaven,
hallowed be thy name.
Thy kin-dom[✕] come, thy will be done,
on earth as it is in heaven.
Give us this day our daily bread.
And forgive us our trespasses as we forgive
those who trespass against us.
Lead us not into temptation,
but deliver us from evil.
For thine is the kin-dom and the power
and the glory forever. *Amen.*

[✕] *Kin-dom represents a hope for God's realm where we are all in community with one another.*

Special Music

Julia Cook, *vocals*

It Came Upon the Midnight Clear

Edmund H. Sears (1849); music and arr. © 2008 Sara Groves; Sara Groves Music (ASCAP)

Reading

Isaiah 9:2, 6-7

Annette Meier

*Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

All Earth is Waiting #210

Alberto Taulè © 1972, 1993 Centro de Pastoral Liturgica, admin. OCP;
Trans. © 1989 The United Methodist Publishing House

Children's Message

Rev. Jean Elliott

Reading

Luke 2:1-7

Annette Meier

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

What Child is This #219

William C. Dix (1865)

Reading

Luke 2:8-20

Dylan Conklin

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

Angels We Have Heard on High #238

Harm. © 1964 Abingdon Press

Sermon

"The Power of a Story"

Rev. Becky Sechrist

Reading

Psalm 96

Annette Meier

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

Joy to the World #246

Isaac Watts (1719) G. F. Handel (1741)

Offering of Gifts and Tithes

Special Music

Judi Bartlett, Julie Darlington, *vocals*

There's A New Kid In Town

©1985 Keith Whitley, Curly Putman, Don Cook (BMI) SONY/ATV Cross Keys Publ. (ASCAP)

Prayer of Dedication

May these gifts of time, talent, and treasure proclaim your saving action in Jesus Christ. Through our offerings, empower this church to share the good news we have seen and heard. Equip us to sing with angels and run with shepherds. Fill us with your peace, that we may live more fully as peacemakers. Expand the horizons of our understanding and expectation, that we may move with confidence into these wider arenas where you call us to serve. Amen.

Hymn

The United Methodist Hymnal (red)

Silent Night #239 (with flashlights)

Joseph Mohr, Franz Gruber (1818)

Benediction

Traveling Music

Hannah Scholen, *vocals*

Christmas Tree Farm

©2019 Taylor Swift; Songs of Universal Inc., TASRM Publ. (BMI)

Today's musicians: Judi Bartlett, Zobeida Bonilla, Satchel Bruna, Julia Cook, Julie Andrews Darlington, Matt Hughes, Hannah Scholen, Tim Siefkes





WELCOME TO ALL VISITING THIS CHRISTMAS EVE!

We're so glad you're here. If you're seeking a church that feels like "home," we hope you'll consider Minnehaha United Methodist Church. We're a thriving multi-generational, multi-cultural congregation. Our Christian faith drives us to take action in our neighborhood through local missions, activism, and sharing the unconditional love of God with our neighbors. We make good things happen here.

We think you'll find ours a community that has a lot to offer:

- A place where **everyone is welcome**
- Faith development in a **positive, non-judgmental** way
- **Meaningful worship** with varied music styles at 9:30 a.m. and a monthly Taize service (2nd Friday of the month)
- **Dynamic children & youth programs** with support for parents
- Lots of opportunities for **service to others**
- The opportunity for close, **life-long friendships**

To find out more, visit our website (www.minnehaha.org) or contact our pastor, Becky Sechrist (becky@minnehaha.org). Thank you for your visit. We hope you'll come back soon.

WINTER STUDIES

- Starting January 4, the Sunday morning Adult Faith Formation class (10:45 a.m.) will be exploring a series from Professor Dr. Amy Jill Levine on the Bible With and Without Jesus.
- Starting January 5, we'll be looking at different theological beliefs on Monday nights at 6:30 p.m. We'll start with concepts like original sin, being saved, and Jesus' second coming and then go on from there. This class will be offered in a hybrid style, so if you can't come in person, then join us utilizing the zoom link we'll have in our weekly enews (or contact becky@minnehaha.org for the link).

POINSETTIAS

THIS CHRISTMAS EVE ARE GIVEN BY:

In celebration of Bryn, Harvey, and Hugo from Jenny & Dean Ammerman

In memory of our parents from Marshall & Margaret Cook

In Memory of LeeAnne Jasper from Cory Dallas

In memory of her brother, Kenneth Kittelson from Wanda Driver

In honor of Doreen Enge from Bud & Diane Enge

In memory of Manny & Arlene Forsberg and Bud Enge

In memory of Charles J. Graham from David Graham

In celebration of family from Sarah Hicks

In celebration of my 75 years at Minnehaha Church from Jan Hougen

In memory of Jerry Baste from Charlene & Craig Johnson

In celebration of our family near and far from Peter & Sue Johnson

In celebration of our grandchildren and great-grandchildren from Susan
& Arlo Johnson

In celebration of Viviana from Charlene & Craig Johnson

In honor of Thomas Nyseth from Rebecca Nyseth

In celebration of CRAFTS (Calista, Ryne, Amy, Francesca, Tyler, and Shane)
from Margaret Rawson

In memory of Bob & Barb Ellison from Patricia Roth

In memory of Joan Ellison from Patricia Roth

In honor of Rebecca Denison - HIV survivor/warrior from Jeanne Ritterson

In memory of Tom Brossart from Kristin & Jacob Southworth

For a more peaceful 2026 for all from Zane Thimmesch-Gill & Ani Goodenberger

In memory of Joyce Thompson from Gene Thompson

December 28

Carol Service

Worship on December 28 will be a service of Christmas carols and the stories behind them.



MINNEHAHA

YOUTH GROUP

Grades 6th-12th

**SUNDAYS
4:00-5:30 PM**

*Come together for
weekly activities,
snacks, and fun in
community!*



Bring your snow gear on Jan. 4 & 18

No Youth Group on Jan. 25



Minnehaha Winter Retreat January 23-25



Lake Koronis Assembly Grounds

Join us for a getaway weekend of winter fun!

Activities for All Ages

Friday Night Gathering

Saturday Morning Programs

-Adults -Youth -Children

Saturday Afternoon Freetime

Saturday Night Talent Show & Dance Party

Sunday Morning Worship

2 Lodging Options

Lakeview Lodge

Twin beds with shared bathrooms
down the hall

Sunrise Inn

Full sized beds with private
bathroom in the room

Register by Jan. 14



Winter Retreat Registration Link: <https://omella.com/c1pwd>